



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Let's find out how we can become more mindful!



Learning Outcome

Understand actions, events, and experiences in present, past or future and in spoken or written texts and in work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- How can meditation help a person's overall health?
- Have you ever tried yoga? How did it go?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about health and wellness.
- I can talk about the reason of an action or an event.
- I can report statements.

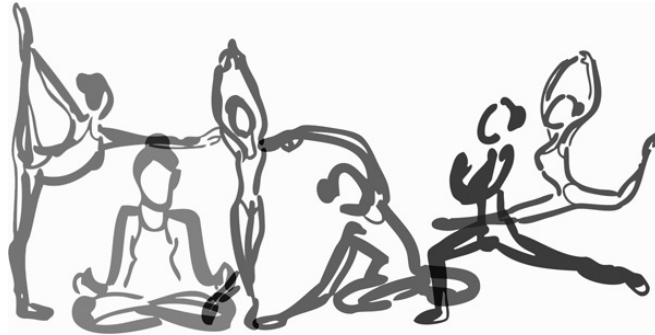




Let's Explore!

Clearing out the **clutter***.

* "Clutter" is an area that is untidy and filled with debris.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

The practice of mindful meditation involves becoming aware of your "stream of consciousness". Mindfulness has been shown to have multiple health benefits, specifically for its proven ability to decrease rumination.

Joseph Hay came across mindfulness after moving to British Columbia. "I was doing a lot of yoga, but I found that my instructors focused exclusively on the physical, almost as if it were just a workout," he says. "That's when I switched to mindful meditation, and I'm so much happier for having discovered it. Since adopting mindfulness, I've noticed a dramatic improvement in my overall well-being."

With so many people living fast-paced lives, it's no wonder there's an increasing need to slow down and take stock of one's thoughts and feelings. Joseph now conducts mindfulness seminars for local businesses.

"If you're in a corporate environment, you spend all of your time worrying about projects and deadlines," he explains. "The goal of my sessions is to get people to slow down and get in touch with their own thoughts."

After speaking with several of his corporate clients during his most recent retreat in Vancouver, it's easy to see why his seminars are completely booked up through the end of the year. The response was almost unanimously positive. Many of them even said that it was a life-altering experience, and that they would strongly advise their colleagues to attend. They promised they would find the time to meditate each day, even with their busy work schedules.

Although the overwhelming majority were satisfied, one distraught employee ended up arriving four hours late and missing the entire session. He remembered writing the event down in his agenda, but he says that he was so busy thinking about his big presentation, he didn't have time to double-check the schedule.

He apologized for missing the seminar. "I guess mindfulness means paying attention to what's going on in the outside world, not just what's going on in my head," he said. "After all, you can't be mindful if your mind is too full."





Let's Practice!

Why don't you consider practicing mindfulness?

Instructions: Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. The practice of mindful meditation involves becoming aware of your stream of consciousness.
2. Mindfulness has been shown to have multiple health benefits.
3. I was doing a lot of yoga, but I found that my instructors focused exclusively on the physical, almost as if it were just a workout.
4. The response was almost unanimously positive.
5. I've noticed a dramatic improvement in my overall well-being.



Let's Practice!

Now you know mindful meditation will always be an option.

Instructions: Match the sentences on the left with their missing parts on the right.

COLUMN A

1. Joseph Hay came across mindfulness after
2. I switched to mindful meditation, and I'm so much happier
3. Since adopting mindfulness,
4. With so many people living fast-paced lives,
5. After speaking with several of his corporate clients,

COLUMN B

- a. moving to British Columbia.
- b. I've noticed a dramatic improvement in my overall well-being.
- c. it's no wonder there's an increasing need to slow down and take stock of one's thoughts and feelings.
- d. it's easy to see why his seminars are completely booked up.
- e. for having discovered it.





Extension Activity

Explain four different yoga poses.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Go online and research different yoga poses.
- Choose four. Draw a picture of each.
- Beside each picture, explain how to properly perform the pose.
- Explain each pose to a partner, and give them a try!

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I research yoga poses.

☐ ☐

I describe how to complete a yoga pose properly.

☐ ☐

I give step-by-step instructions to a partner.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **mindfulness** (noun): the practice of being aware of your mind and body
e.g. Mindfulness has been shown to have multiple health benefits.
- **rumination** (noun): to think deeply about something; to worry
e.g. It is known specifically for its proven ability to decrease rumination.
- **workout** (noun): a period of physical exercise
e.g. I found that my instructors focused exclusively on the physical, almost as if it were just a workout.
- **well-being** (noun): health or welfare
e.g. Since adopting mindfulness, I've noticed a dramatic improvement in my overall well-being.
- **fast-paced** (adjective): happening extremely quickly
e.g. The law office was a fast-paced environment in which to work.
- **to take stock** (expression): to think about
e.g. With so many people living fast-paced lives, it's no wonder there's an increasing need to slow down and take stock of one's thoughts and feelings.
- **retreat** (noun): a quiet, private trip
e.g. After speaking with several of his corporate clients during his most recent retreat in Vancouver, it's easy to see why his seminars are completely booked up through the end of the year.





Learning Points

Giving Reasons: *For*, *With* and *-ing* Clauses

You use reason clauses to express the reasons for an action, or why a situation is the way it is.

You can use words like *for* or *with* to introduce a noun phrase to give a reason for something, or use an *-ing* form of a verb to introduce a reason clause.

Reason clauses are subordinate to the main clause. They state the reason why things are done, or what makes a situation the way it is.

You can use *for* or *with* to introduce a noun phrase that gives a reason for a situation.

Example:

With *so many people interested in mindfulness, it's no wonder this seminar is completely booked up.*

*She looked so much happier **for** her participation in the seminar.*

You can use *-ing* clauses to express reason relationships between the main clause and the subordinate clause.

Example:

*We queued for over two hours, **hoping** to get tickets to the seminar.*

Having *met the speaker personally, I can vouch for his enthusiasm.*

Read the following examples from the text:

Examples:

- *Joseph Hay came across mindfulness after moving to British Columbia.*
- *That's when I switched to mindful meditation, and I'm so much happier for having discovered it.*
- *Since adopting mindfulness, I've noticed a dramatic improvement in my overall well-being.*
- *With so many people living fast-paced lives, it's no wonder there's an increasing need to slow down and take stock of one's thoughts and feelings.*





Learning Points

Infinitive and *-ing* Forms in Reporting

You use infinitive clauses and *-ing* forms to report statements, orders or questions in indirect speech.

You use reported speech to report statements or situations.

You can use infinitive clauses to report someone else's thoughts or statements.

Example:

Direct Speech: **Jimmy**: *I promise to come with you the next time.*
changes to

Reported Speech: Jimmy promised **to come** with us the next time.

Direct Speech **Sarah**: *Do not miss the next seminar.*

changes to

Reported Speech: Sarah strongly advised me **not to miss** the next seminar.

You use *-ing* forms to report actions. You sometimes need a preposition with some verbs.

Example:

Direct Speech: **Tom**: *I'm sorry I missed the seminar.*

changes to

Reported Speech: Tom **apologized for missing** the seminar.

Direct Speech: **Gina**: *I know I wrote the event down in my agenda.*

changes to

Reported Speech: Gina **recalled/remembered writing** the event down in her agenda.

Read the following examples from the text:

Examples:

- *Many of them even said that it was a life-altering experience, and that they would strongly advise their colleagues to attend.*
- *They promised they would find the time to meditate each day, even with their busy work schedules.*
- *He remembered writing the event down in his agenda, but he says that he was so busy thinking about his big presentation that he didn't have time to double check the schedule.*
- *He apologized for missing the seminar.*

